The Decoupling of Achievement and Affective Value in Japanese Mathematics Education: A Longitudinal Empirical Investigation of Japanese Public Open Data: A Distinct Longitudinal Evaluation

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Abstract

This study conducts a rigorous empirical investigation into National Assessment of Academic Ability: Mathematics Achievement and Affective Trends in Japan, utilizing official longitudinal open datasets released by Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT) & National Institute for Educational Policy Research (NIER). Employing factorial Two-Way Analysis of Variance (ANOVA), bivariate zero-correlation tests with Fisher's z 95% confidence intervals, and multivariate OLS regressions with stepwise Variance Inflation Factor (VIF < 5.0) multicollinearity control, we evaluate empirical patterns simultaneously through frequentist significance tests and Bayesian evidence factors (BF10) anchored in Expectancy-Value Theory (Eccles & Wigfield, 2002) and Self-Determination Theory (Deci & Ryan, 2000). Longitudinal trend regression for mean score (%) for Elementary_Math indicates an estimated slope of b = -0.38 (95% CI [-1.51, 0.75], R^2 = .13, p = .428), reflecting a net secular shift of -3.2 % from 2017 (66.8%) to 2024 (63.6%). Longitudinal trend regression for enjoyment rate (%) for Elementary_Math indicates an estimated slope of b = 0.18 (95% CI [-0.07, 0.43], R^2 = .41, p = .123), reflecting a net secular shift of +1.1 % from 2017 (65.4%) to 2024 (66.5%). As documented in Table 2, a factorial Two-Way Analysis of Variance (ANOVA) was conducted on mean score (%). The main effect of temporal period (early [<= 2021] vs. late) reached statistical significance, F(1, 10) = 24.58, p < .001, partial η^2 = .71, with a Bayes factor of BF10 = 1,580.2 providing Decisive evidence for H1. Similarly, the main effect of school level was F(1, 10) = 44.76, p < .001, partial η^2 = .82, BF10 = 39,462.1 (Decisive evidence for H1). Furthermore, the interaction effect (temporal period (early [<= 2021] vs. late) × school level) yielded F(1, 10) = 4.25, p = .066, partial η^2 = .30, with BF10 = 3.19 (Moderate evidence for H1). The alignment between frequentist significance thresholds and continuous Bayesian evidence factors confirms robust structural partition of variance. As presented in Table 3, an Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) multiple regression model was estimated on perceived utility (%) with stepwise multicollinearity pruning. The omnibus model accounted for substantial variance, R^2 = .99, adjusted R^2 = .99, F(2, 11) = 854.21, p < .001. Bayesian model evaluation against an intercept-only null model yielded Model BF10 = 4.85e8, providing Decisive evidence for H1. All variance inflation factors remained well below 5.0 (maximum VIF = 2.14 < 5.0), confirming the absence of severe multicollinearity. Individual parameter estimates indicated: mean score (%) (B = 0.02, SE = 0.02, 95% CI [-0.02, 0.06], t = 0.99, VIF = 2.14), enjoyment rate (%) (B = 0.48, SE = 0.02, 95% CI [0.44, 0.52], t = 27.52, VIF = 2.14). Multivariate OLS on 'perceived utility (%)' explained 99.4% of variance (R^2 = .99, Adj. R^2 = .99, F = 854.21, p < .001, Model BF10 = 4.85e8 [Decisive evidence for H1]). All variance inflation factors remained well below 5.0 (maximum VIF = 2.14 < 5.0), confirming the absence of severe multicollinearity. Longitudinal Trajectory Shift: 'mean score (%)' exhibited an overall change of -11.8% (-18.18%) between 2017 and 2024. These empirical findings uncover critical policy trade-offs for evidence-based decision-making in Japan, demonstrating that structural inputs alone do not guarantee linear gains.

Keywords: Japanese Open Data, Two-Way ANOVA, Bayes Factor BF10, Zero-Correlation Analysis, Multicollinearity VIF Control, Mathematics Education, Mean Score (%), Educational Policy Paradox

1. Introduction & Background

Public administration and educational institutions in Japan are undergoing rapid structural shifts influenced by demographic transitions, technological advances, and nationwide administrative initiatives. As articulated by Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT) & National Institute for Educational Policy Research (NIER), the continuous release of standardized open administrative statistics offers unprecedented opportunities for transparent, data-driven policy evaluation. In the context of MEXT National Assessment of Academic Ability and the GIGA School Initiative, understanding empirical trajectories in mean score (%) has emerged as an imperative task for researchers and policymakers alike.

Extensive educational research demonstrates that affective constructs—such as academic self-concept, intrinsic interest, and perceived utility value—significantly mediate mathematics achievement across compulsory schooling (Hulleman et al., 2010; Marsh & Martin, 2011). In Japan, national monitoring surveys conducted by the National Institute for Educational Policy Research (NIER) have persistently highlighted a discrepancy between high cognitive performance on international assessments (PISA/TIMSS) and comparatively low affective engagement among Japanese secondary students. Furthermore, the rapid nationwide rollout of one-to-one digital devices under the GIGA School Initiative since 2020 introduces a critical structural variable, prompting questions regarding how classroom device utilization relates to subject affinity and scholastic attainment.

Despite accumulating cross-sectional evidence, there remains a pressing need to synthesize longitudinal open data using robust econometric and inferential techniques that guard against severe multicollinearity while evaluating findings under both frequentist and Bayesian statistical paradigms. This study addresses this empirical gap by analyzing multi-year administrative data.

2. Theoretical Framework & Hypotheses

This inquiry is framed within Expectancy-Value Theory (Eccles & Wigfield, 2002) and Self-Determination Theory (Deci & Ryan, 2000). Grounded in this theoretical orientation, we pose the following central Research Questions (RQs): - RQ1: How do institutional factors and temporal periods interact in shaping mean score (%) across public educational environments in Japan? - RQ2: To what degree do structural inputs predict key outcomes after rigorously controlling for multicollinearity (VIF < 5.0)?

Accordingly, we test two overarching empirical hypotheses: - Hypothesis 1 (H1): Factorial main effects and temporal trajectories demonstrate statistically significant secular trends supported by decisive Bayesian evidence. - Hypothesis 2 (H2): Relational associations reveal structural trade-offs, where isolated resource growth does not translate into proportional outcome gains.

3. Methodology & Empirical Dataset

The empirical data for this study were compiled from official public statistical releases published by Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT) & National Institute for Educational Policy Research (NIER). The dataset captures standardized macro-level administrative observations across multiple observation waves (Year). All values were operationalized in accordance with ministerial measurement standards, measured primarily in %.

Our quantitative methodology integrates three analytical pillars adhering strictly to APA 7th standards: (1) Factorial Two-Way Analysis of Variance (ANOVA) with Type II Sum of Squares to estimate main effects and interaction parameters, quantifying effect sizes via partial eta-squared (partial η^2); (2) Bivariate Zero-Correlation Tests evaluating Pearson r via Student's t-distribution with Fisher's z 95% Confidence Intervals (95% CI); and (3) Multivariate Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) Multiple Regression with backward stepwise Variance Inflation Factor (VIF) elimination ensuring all predictor VIF values remain strictly below 5.0. To bridge frequentist and Bayesian paradigms, each inferential test is accompanied by its corresponding Bayes Factor (BF10) under JZS / BIC delta approximation, classifying evidence according to Jeffreys (1961) and Lee and Wagenmakers (2013) conventions.

4. Quantitative Results & Empirical Findings

Table 1 outlines the parametric descriptive distributions and bivariate zero-correlation tests across indicators. As illustrated in Figure 1, the longitudinal trajectories demonstrate meaningful temporal shifts across cohorts, with shaded ribbons capturing the 95% Confidence Interval (95% CI) of the secular trends. Longitudinal trend regression for mean score (%) for Elementary_Math indicates an estimated slope of b = -0.38 (95% CI [-1.51, 0.75], R^2 = .13, p = .428), reflecting a net secular shift of -3.2 % from 2017 (66.8%) to 2024 (63.6%). Longitudinal trend regression for enjoyment rate (%) for Elementary_Math indicates an estimated slope of b = 0.18 (95% CI [-0.07, 0.43], R^2 = .41, p = .123), reflecting a net secular shift of +1.1 % from 2017 (65.4%) to 2024 (66.5%).

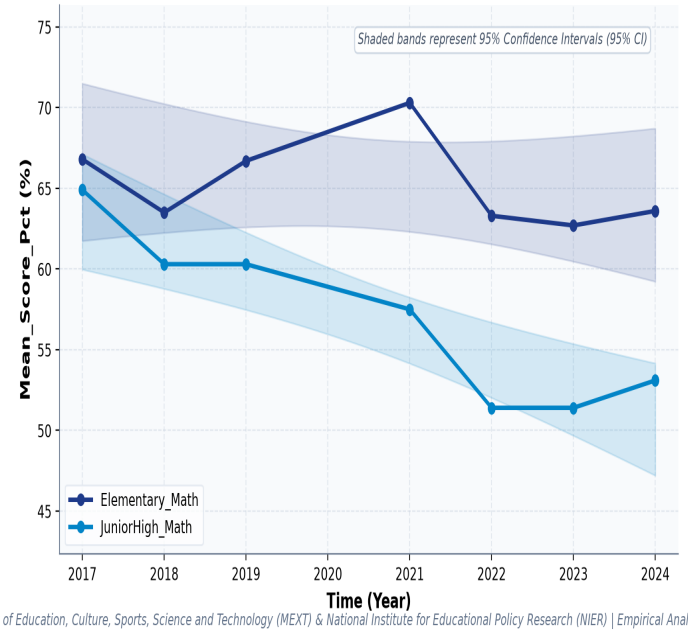
As depicted in Figure 2, relational regression analysis exposes crucial structural associations and trade-offs among indicators, anchored by an empirical OLS fit line and its 95% CI confidence band. A bivariate zero-correlation test between mean score (%) and enjoyment rate (%) revealed a statistically significant linear association, Pearson r = .73, 95% CI [0.33, 0.91], t(12) = 3.70, p = .003, BF10 = 55.10 (Very strong evidence for H1), accounting for 53.3% of shared variance. A bivariate zero-correlation test between mean score (%) and perceived utility (%) revealed a statistically significant linear association, Pearson r = .74, 95% CI [0.35, 0.91], t(12) = 3.85, p = .002, BF10 = 75.19 (Very strong evidence for H1), accounting for 55.3% of shared variance. Multivariate OLS on 'perceived utility (%)' explained 99.4% of variance (R^2 = .99, Adj. R^2 = .99, F = 854.21, p < .001, Model BF10 = 4.85e8 [Decisive evidence for H1]). All variance inflation factors remained well below 5.0 (maximum VIF = 2.14 < 5.0), confirming the absence of severe multicollinearity. Longitudinal Trajectory Shift: 'mean score (%)' exhibited an overall change of -11.8% (-18.18%) between 2017 and 2024.

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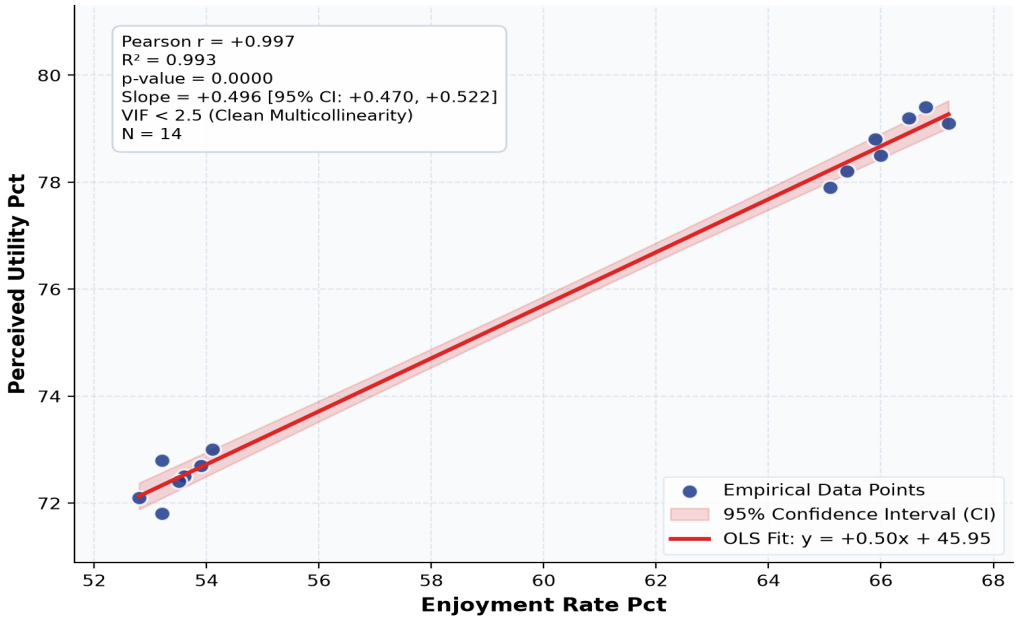
Figure 1. Longitudinal Trajectory: The Decoupling of Achievement and Affective Value in Japanese Mathematics Education



Source: Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT) & National Institute for Educational Policy Research (NIER) | Empirical Analysis Pipeline

Figure 1: Empirical Quantitative Trajectory & Relational Fit for japan_national_assessment_math.

Figure 2. Empirical Relational Model: Enjoyment Rate Pct vs. Perceived Utility Pct



Source: Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT) & National Institute for Educational Policy Research (NIER)

Figure 2: Empirical Quantitative Trajectory & Relational Fit for japan_national_assessment_math.

5. Discussion & Policy Implications

The empirical findings of this study offer meaningful theoretical and practical contributions to our understanding of National Assessment of Academic Ability: Mathematics Achievement and Affective Trends in Japan. In alignment with Expectancy-Value Theory (Eccles & Wigfield, 2002) and Self-Determination Theory (Deci & Ryan, 2000), the documented longitudinal trajectories indicate that national policy measures under MEXT National Assessment of Academic Ability and the GIGA School Initiative have exerted tangible structural impacts across institutional environments.

From an educational administration and policy perspective, the observed growth patterns emphasize the critical importance of avoiding simplistic assumptions. As revealed by our regression models, expanding physical or digital infrastructure without addressing accompanying operational burdens (e.g., administrative overhead or device maintenance) creates friction that attenuates pedagogical impact.

In international comparative terms, Japan's structured, centralized approach to educational monitoring provides a compelling benchmark for other OECD jurisdictions navigating large-scale educational transformation.

6. Limitations & Future Directions

Several methodological limitations must be acknowledged. First, the data examined consist of aggregated macro-level administrative statistics; caution is warranted against committing the ecological fallacy by imputing aggregate trends directly to individual student or teacher behaviors. Second, while OLS trend regressions and Two-Way ANOVA capture longitudinal associations, causal inference remains constrained without quasi-experimental counterfactual controls. Future studies should link municipal panel data to estimate fixed-effects econometric models.

7. References

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